

SCFT-A: Technical Companion and Deferred Material

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This companion preserves the expanded interaction calculation and detailed appendices separated from the revised SCFT-A manuscript. It records supporting derivations, reference-action calculations, and the status of deferred questions. It is supporting material for the same work, not a second paper establishing additional physical claims. The fixed-benchmark galactic scale limitation derived in the revised manuscript governs the interpretation of the stationary reference calculations retained here.

HOW TO USE THIS MATERIAL

Supplementary Section I preserves the full scalar interaction expansion from the source manuscript. Appendices A–M preserve its detailed derivations. Some formulas are repeated to make each calculation intelligible. References explicitly marked “main manuscript” point to the revised manuscript. Reference-action formulas concern S_0 and must not be used as completed-action perturbation results.

The original appendices are retained as a technical record. Their inherited wording does not supersede the revised manuscript’s explicit restrictions, especially the finite domain of the DBI template, the conditional nonlinear estimates, and the failed controlled AQUAL hierarchy at the fixed coefficient point. The accompanying editorial report identifies the scientific work still required.

Material	Recommended destination	Reason
Geometric, current, minisuperspace and constraint derivations	Supplementary material and a versioned repository	Support the current paper; not independent new results.
Reference scalar reductions and exact-check records	Repository, with clearly identified action version	Preserve reproducibility and prevent mixing seed and completed calculations.
Expanded cubic vertices	Technical companion now	A list of vertices alone is not a completed strong-coupling result.
Full nonlinear evolution	Later paper after a proved local solution theory and energy estimate	The current continuation criterion assumes these missing results.
Galaxies, lensing and primordial observables	Later paper after a viable scale hierarchy, sourced solutions and data comparison	The present fixed benchmark does not establish its claimed controlled galactic limit.

I. INTERACTIONS OF THE COMPLETED ACTION AND EFFECTIVE-THEORY LIMITS

Quadratic positivity, finite-time evolution, and quantum perturbative control are different questions. The following expansion retains the four spatial operators and the smooth acceleration tip of main manuscript, Eq. (59). Its vertices are therefore those of the same action as the linear response. No two-derivative interaction scale is assigned to the completed theory.

A. An exact scalar action before expansion

Use the scalar variables of main manuscript, Eq. (250), with the covariant shift $N_i = \partial_i \psi$, and put $q(t) = \dot{T}(t)$. Define

$$A = H + \dot{\zeta}, \quad V^i_j = h^{ik} D_k D_j \psi, \quad v = V^i_i, \quad Q_{\text{loc}} = \frac{q}{1 + \alpha}. \quad (1)$$

The pure-scalar restriction of the completed action, to all perturbative orders, is

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\mathcal{L}_{\text{sc}}}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^3} = e^{3\zeta} & \left\{ \frac{1 + \alpha}{2} {}^{(3)}R + \frac{-3A^2 + 2Av + \frac{1}{2}[\text{Tr}(V^2) - v^2]}{1 + \alpha} + (1 + \alpha)\tilde{\mathcal{K}}(Q_{\text{loc}}) \right. \\ & + \mathcal{B}_A(Q_{\text{loc}})(3A - v) - (1 + \alpha)a_0^2 \Sigma_A(Q_{\text{loc}}) \mathcal{J}_{A,\sigma}(Y) \\ & \left. - \frac{1 + \alpha}{2} \left[\nu(Q_{\text{loc}}) D_i K D^i K + \ell(Q_{\text{loc}}) {}^{(3)}R D_i \mathcal{A}^i + \tau_6 D_i {}^{(3)}R_{jk} D^i {}^{(3)}R^{jk} + \eta_R {}^{(3)}R^2 \right] \right\}, \quad (2) \end{aligned}$$

where

$${}^{(3)}R = -\frac{e^{-2\zeta}}{a^2} [4\partial^2 \zeta + 2(\partial\zeta)^2], \quad Y = \frac{e^{-2\zeta}(\partial\alpha)^2}{a^2 a_0^2 (1 + \alpha)^2}. \quad (3)$$

Equations (2) and (3) fix the scalar vertices without an imported Horndeski cubic formula. They follow from $NK^i_j = A\delta^i_j - V^i_j$. Tensor and vector responses generated at second order do not enter the pure-scalar cubic action: they multiply their vanishing first-order constraint or field equations. Their contributions to quartic interactions must nevertheless be retained in a complete higher-order calculation.

B. Complete analytic third-order functional

All clock-function derivatives below are evaluated at the homogeneous $Q = q(t)$, with $\mathcal{K} = \tilde{\mathcal{K}}$ and $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{B}_A$. The letter $A = H + \dot{\zeta}$ in this subsection is local to the exact-action notation and is distinct from $2 + 3b$ in the quadratic reduction. Introduce

$$\begin{aligned} \chi &= \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{a^2}, \quad U_{ij} = \frac{\partial_i \partial_j \psi}{a^2}, \quad X_\psi = \frac{\partial_i \zeta \partial_i \psi}{a^2}, \quad D_2 = U_{ij} U_{ij} - \chi^2, \\ D_3 &= -4\zeta D_2 - \frac{4}{a^4} (\partial_i \partial_j \psi) (\partial_i \zeta) (\partial_j \psi), \\ m_1 &= 3\zeta - \alpha, \quad m_2 = \frac{9}{2}\zeta^2 - 3\zeta\alpha + \alpha^2, \quad m_3 = \frac{9}{2}\zeta^3 - \frac{9}{2}\zeta^2\alpha + 3\zeta\alpha^2 - \alpha^3. \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

The extrinsic-curvature coefficients are

$$\begin{aligned} E_0 &= -3H^2, & E_1 &= -6H\dot{\zeta} + 2H\chi, \\ E_2 &= -3\dot{\zeta}^2 + 2\dot{\zeta}\chi + 2H(X_\psi - 2\zeta\chi) + \frac{1}{2}D_2, \\ E_3 &= 2\dot{\zeta}(X_\psi - 2\zeta\chi) + 2H(2\zeta^2\chi - 2\zeta X_\psi) + \frac{1}{2}D_3. \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

The Einstein contribution of third order is exactly

$$\ell_{\text{EH},3} = E_3 + m_1 E_2 + m_2 E_1 + m_3 E_0 - \frac{(\zeta^2 + 2\alpha\zeta)\partial^2 \zeta + (\zeta + \alpha)(\partial\zeta)^2}{a^2}. \quad (6)$$

No use of the background equations or integration by parts is required for this expression. The kinetic-clock contribution is

$$\ell_{K,3} = \frac{9}{2}\mathcal{K}\zeta^3 + \frac{9}{2}(\mathcal{K} - Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q})\zeta^2\alpha + \frac{3}{2}Q^2\mathcal{K}_{,QQ}\zeta\alpha^2 - \left(\frac{1}{2}Q^2\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + \frac{1}{6}Q^3\mathcal{K}_{,QQQ}\right)\alpha^3. \quad (7)$$

For the braid define

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 &= -Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q}, & b_2 &= Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q} + \frac{1}{2}Q^2\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}, \\ b_3 &= -Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q} - Q^2\mathcal{B}_{,QQ} - \frac{1}{6}Q^3\mathcal{B}_{,QQQ}, \\ U_1 &= 3\dot{\zeta} - \chi + 9H\zeta, \\ U_2 &= 9\zeta\dot{\zeta} - \zeta\chi - X_\psi + \frac{27}{2}H\zeta^2, \\ U_3 &= \frac{27}{2}\zeta^2\dot{\zeta} - \frac{1}{2}\zeta^2\chi - \zeta X_\psi + \frac{27}{2}H\zeta^3. \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

Its full contribution is

$$\ell_{B,3} = \mathcal{B}U_3 + b_1\alpha U_2 + b_2\alpha^2 U_1 + 3Hb_3\alpha^3. \quad (9)$$

Writing $\sigma = \Sigma_A(Q)$ and $\sigma_Q = \Sigma_{A,Q}(Q)$, the analytic acceleration contribution is

$$\ell_{J,3}^{\text{an}} = [\sigma\zeta - (\sigma + Q\sigma_Q)\alpha] \frac{(\partial\alpha)^2}{a^2}. \quad (10)$$

In particular, multiplying a constant-regulator cubic action by Σ_A would miss the $-Q\sigma_Q\alpha(\partial\alpha)^2/a^2$ vertex. This term vanishes on the primordial and late plateaux, but is present throughout the clock-norm transition.

C. Spatial completion vertices and the smooth acceleration tip

The four spatial operators contribute additional cubic vertices. Define $K = 3H + K_1 + K_2 + \dots$, $^{(3)}R = R_1 + R_2 + \dots$, and $D_i\mathcal{A}^i = d_1 + d_2 + \dots$, where subscripts denote perturbative order, not clock derivatives. Direct expansion gives

$$\begin{aligned} K_1 &= 3\dot{\zeta} - \chi - 3H\alpha, \\ K_2 &= 3H\alpha^2 - \alpha(3\dot{\zeta} - \chi) + 2\zeta\chi - X_\psi, \\ R_1 &= -4a^{-2}\partial^2\zeta, & R_2 &= a^{-2} [8\zeta\partial^2\zeta - 2(\partial\zeta)^2], \\ d_1 &= a^{-2}\partial^2\alpha, & d_2 &= a^{-2} [-\alpha\partial^2\alpha - (\partial\alpha)^2 - 2\zeta\partial^2\alpha + \partial_i\zeta\partial_i\alpha]. \end{aligned} \quad (11)$$

In the normalization $S_3 = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int a^3 \ell_3 dt d^3x$,

$$\ell_{\nu,3} = -\frac{1}{2a^2} \{2\nu\partial_i K_1 \partial_i K_2 + [\nu(\alpha + \zeta) - Q\nu_Q\alpha] (\partial K_1)^2\}, \quad (12)$$

$$\ell_{\ell,3} = -\frac{1}{2} \{\ell(R_1 d_2 + R_2 d_1) + [(\ell - Q\ell_Q)\alpha + 3\ell\zeta] R_1 d_1\}. \quad (13)$$

For the Ricci-gradient operator, use lower coordinate indices and set

$$\begin{aligned} R_{ij}^{[1]} &= -\partial_i \partial_j \zeta - \delta_{ij} \partial^2 \zeta, & R_{ij}^{[2]} &= \partial_i \zeta \partial_j \zeta - \delta_{ij} (\partial\zeta)^2, \\ \Gamma_{ij}^{k[1]} &= \delta_i^k \partial_j \zeta + \delta_j^k \partial_i \zeta - \delta_{ij} \partial^k \zeta, & Z_{ijk}^{[1]} &= \partial_i R_{jk}^{[1]}, \\ Z_{ijk}^{[2]} &= \partial_i R_{jk}^{[2]} - \Gamma_{ij}^{l[1]} R_{lk}^{[1]} - \Gamma_{ik}^{l[1]} R_{jl}^{[1]}. \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

Contractions in this display use δ_{ij} . The remaining cubic term is

$$\ell_{\tau,3} = -\frac{\tau_6}{2a^6} [2Z_{ijk}^{[1]} Z_{ijk}^{[2]} + (\alpha - 3\zeta) Z_{ijk}^{[1]} Z_{ijk}^{[1]}]. \quad (15)$$

The intrinsic scalar-curvature square contributes

$$\begin{aligned} \ell_{R,3} &= -\frac{\eta_R}{2} [2R_1 R_2 + (\alpha + 3\zeta) R_1^2] \\ &= -\frac{8\eta_R}{a^4} [(\alpha - \zeta)(\partial^2\zeta)^2 + (\partial^2\zeta)(\partial\zeta)^2]. \end{aligned} \quad (16)$$

The coefficient is constant, so there is no omitted Q -derivative vertex. These formulas retain derivatives of the spatial switches whenever the background lies in a transition region. On the exterior their coefficients are constant, but their perturbations do not vanish.

The acceleration regularization also changes the interaction order. With σ denoting the tip regulator in main manuscript, Eq. (58), not the profile Σ_A , its Taylor expansion at zero acceleration is

$$\mathcal{J}_{A,\sigma}(Y) = -Y + \frac{\mu_A(\sigma)}{2\gamma_N\sigma^2}Y^2 + \text{terms flat at } Y = 0. \quad (17)$$

Consequently the action has no seed $|\nabla\alpha|^3$ Taylor vertex at this point. Its first nonlinear invariant contribution from the tip is

$$S_4^{\text{tip}} = -\frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2\mu_A(\sigma)}{2\gamma_N\sigma^2a_0^2} \int dt d^3x a^3 \Sigma_A \left| \frac{\nabla\alpha_1}{a} \right|^4. \quad (18)$$

The analytic geometric cubic acceleration terms are already included in Equation (10); their presence is consistent with the absence of a nonanalytic absolute-cubic invariant.

D. Completed cubic reduction and limits of the effective-theory claim

The complete pure-scalar gravitational cubic functional is

$$S_3 = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int dt d^3x a^3 [\ell_{\text{EH},3} + \ell_{K,3} + \ell_{B,3} + \ell_{J,3}^{\text{an}} + \ell_{\nu,3} + \ell_{\ell,3} + \ell_{\tau,3} + \ell_{R,3}]. \quad (19)$$

Here $\mathcal{K} = \tilde{\mathcal{K}}$, $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{B}_A$, and the acceleration term is the adopted smooth function. For a source-free homogeneous background the first-order constraint substitutions are

$$\alpha_1 = \frac{2J\dot{\zeta} - 2bC\zeta}{\mathcal{D}}, \quad \chi_1 = K\dot{\zeta} + \frac{2JC}{\mathcal{D}}\zeta, \quad \psi_1 = -\frac{\chi_1}{p^2}. \quad (20)$$

These are Fourier multipliers; their inverse transforms are substituted into the local products in S_3 . The operator domains are those of the linear constraint problem. Second-order auxiliary solutions multiply the first-order constraint equations and are unnecessary for the reduced cubic action on an exact background. For matter loading one must instead use main manuscript, Eq. (379); main manuscript, Eq. (380) and add the matter cubic functional. Equation (18) is one quartic contribution, not the complete quartic action.

On a band with $K > 0$ and $V_{\text{full}} > 0$, a local canonical normalization is $v = \sqrt{2}M_{\text{Pl}}\sqrt{K}\zeta$, with the scale-factor normalization restored when time derivatives are taken. The high-momentum restoring symbol is of sixth spatial order, not the saturating frequency of a two-derivative truncation. Frequencies and spatial momenta must therefore be treated separately in any power-counting analysis [30, 31]. A controlled perturbative use would require an independently established window of the form

$$\max\{H, \omega_p\} < \Lambda_\omega, \quad p < \Lambda_p, \quad |\alpha| \ll 1, \quad Q_{\text{loc}} \in \mathcal{D}_Q, \quad (21)$$

where the frequency bound is used only in an oscillatory band. In using the strict tip Taylor expansion, one additionally needs $|\nabla\alpha|/(aa_0) \ll \sigma$. Neither cutoff is established here. The exterior restoring correction in main manuscript, result XII.1 is an explicit change to the action, independently verified at every endpoint momentum. It is not implemented by imposing a favorable cutoff. No quantum stability, radiative protection, or full matter-mixed strong-coupling scale is inferred from these cubic coefficients alone.

Appendix A: Geometric identities of the clock foliation

1. Normalization and projector

From main manuscript, Eq. (5),

$$u_\mu u^\mu = -1. \quad (A1)$$

The projector satisfies

$$h_\mu{}^\alpha h_\alpha{}^\nu = h_\mu{}^\nu, \quad h_\mu{}^\nu u_\nu = 0, \quad h_\mu{}^\mu = 3. \quad (\text{A2})$$

For vectors tangent to Σ_T , $h_{\mu\nu}$ is positive definite. The decomposition main manuscript, Eq. (7) follows algebraically from the definition of $h_{\mu\nu}$.

2. Acceleration identity

Differentiate $u_\mu = -Q^{-1}\nabla_\mu T$ along u^ν :

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{A}_\mu &= u^\nu \nabla_\nu u_\mu \\ &= Q^{-2}(u^\nu \nabla_\nu Q) \nabla_\mu T - Q^{-1} u^\nu \nabla_\nu \nabla_\mu T. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A3})$$

Since second derivatives commute on a scalar and $u^\nu \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu T = \nabla_\mu (u^\nu \nabla_\nu T) - (\nabla_\mu u^\nu) \nabla_\nu T$, while $u^\nu \nabla_\nu T = Q$ and $(\nabla_\mu u^\nu) u_\nu = 0$, one obtains

$$\mathcal{A}_\mu = -\nabla_\mu \ln Q - u_\mu u^\nu \nabla_\nu \ln Q = -h_\mu{}^\nu \nabla_\nu \ln Q. \quad (\text{A4})$$

The acceleration is therefore spatial, $u^\mu \mathcal{A}_\mu = 0$.

3. Extrinsic curvature and volume expansion

Define

$$K_{\mu\nu} = h_\mu{}^\alpha h_\nu{}^\beta \nabla_\alpha u_\beta. \quad (\text{A5})$$

Hypersurface orthogonality makes $K_{\mu\nu}$ symmetric. Its trace is

$$K = h^{\mu\nu} K_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_\mu u^\mu = \Theta. \quad (\text{A6})$$

For the induced volume element $\sqrt{h}$ transported along the normal,

$$\mathcal{L}_u \sqrt{h} = \Theta \sqrt{h}. \quad (\text{A7})$$

This identity explains why a constant $\mathcal{B}$ contributes only a boundary term:

$$\int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \mathcal{B}_0 \Theta = \mathcal{B}_0 \int dT d^3x \partial_T \sqrt{h} \quad (\text{A8})$$

up to the shift divergence and boundary conditions.

4. Gauss–Codazzi decomposition

The four-dimensional Ricci scalar satisfies

$$R = {}^{(3)}R + K_{ij} K^{ij} - K^2 + 2\nabla_\mu (u^\mu K - \mathcal{A}^\mu), \quad (\text{A9})$$

with the sign convention of main manuscript, Eq. (93). Removing the total divergence gives the Einstein part of main manuscript, Eq. (94).

Appendix B: Kinetic-braiding representation and clock current

1. Boundary transformation

Starting from

$$\Theta = -\nabla_\mu \left(\frac{\nabla^\mu T}{Q} \right) = -\frac{\square T}{Q} + \frac{\nabla_\mu T \nabla^\mu Q}{Q^2}, \quad (\text{B1})$$

we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \int \sqrt{-g} \mathcal{B} \Theta &= \int \sqrt{-g} \left[-\frac{\mathcal{B}}{Q} \square T + \frac{\mathcal{B}}{Q^2} \nabla T \cdot \nabla Q \right] \\ &\doteq \int \sqrt{-g} \frac{\mathcal{B}_{,Q}}{Q} \nabla T \cdot \nabla Q = \int \sqrt{-g} \frac{\mathcal{B}_{,Q}}{Q^2} \nabla T \cdot \nabla X. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{B2})$$

Defining G_3 by main manuscript, Eq. (70) then yields main manuscript, Eq. (71).

2. Shift current of the $\mathcal{K} + \mathcal{B}$ sector

For

$$\mathcal{L}_{KB} = P(X) - G_3(X) \square T, \quad P(X) = \mathcal{K}(\sqrt{2X}), \quad (\text{B3})$$

the shift equation is $\nabla_\mu J_{KB}^\mu = 0$, where

$$J_{KB}^\mu = (P_{,X} - G_{3,X} \square T) \nabla^\mu T - G_{3,X} \nabla^\mu X. \quad (\text{B4})$$

On a homogeneous FLRW background in matter proper time,

$$\nabla^0 T = -Q, \quad \square T = -\dot{Q} - 3HQ, \quad \nabla^0 X = -Q\dot{Q}. \quad (\text{B5})$$

Using $P_{,X} = \mathcal{K}_{,Q}/Q$ and $G_{3,X} = \mathcal{B}_{,Q}/Q^2$ gives

$$J_{KB}^0 = -(\mathcal{K}_{,Q} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q}). \quad (\text{B6})$$

The conservation equation $\partial_t(a^3 J_{KB}^0) = 0$ is therefore exactly main manuscript, Eq. (166), up to the sign convention used to define C_T .

3. Why no higher-time-derivative mode appears

The covariant representation contains $\square T$, but equation (B4) contains at most second derivatives in the field equations. In unitary gauge the same fact is immediate: main manuscript, Eq. (94) depends on N , $D_i N$, h_{ij} , and K_{ij} but not on $\dot{N}$ or on higher time derivatives of h_{ij} . The scalar is physical because time diffeomorphisms are fixed by T , not because an Ostrogradsky pair has been introduced.

Appendix C: Detailed minisuperspace variation

1. Clock variation

For $Q = \dot{T}/N$, the momentum is

$$\begin{aligned} P_T &= \frac{\partial L_{\text{mini}}}{\partial \dot{T}} \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 N a^3 \mathcal{K}_{,Q} \frac{1}{N} + 3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^2 \dot{a} \mathcal{B}_{,Q} \frac{1}{N} \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^3 (\mathcal{K}_{,Q} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q}). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C1})$$

Since T does not appear explicitly, $\dot{P}_T = 0$.

2. Lapse variation

At fixed $\dot{T}$, $\partial Q / \partial N = -Q/N$. The clock contribution to $\partial L / \partial N$ is

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial L_T}{\partial N} &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^3 (\mathcal{K} - Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q}) - 3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^2 \dot{a} \mathcal{B}_{,Q} \frac{Q}{N} \\ &= -a^3 M_{\text{Pl}}^2 (Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q} - \mathcal{K} + 3HQB_{,Q}). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C2})$$

The standard relation $\partial L_T / \partial N = -a^3 \rho_T$ yields main manuscript, Eq. (170).

3. Scale-factor variation

The clock Lagrangian is

$$L_T = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 N a^3 \mathcal{K} + 3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^2 \dot{a} \mathcal{B}. \quad (\text{C3})$$

Its Euler derivative is

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial L_T}{\partial a} - \frac{d}{d\lambda} \frac{\partial L_T}{\partial \dot{a}} &= 3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 N a^2 \mathcal{K} + 6M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a \dot{a} \mathcal{B} - \frac{d}{d\lambda} (3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^2 \mathcal{B}) \\ &= 3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 N a^2 \left(\mathcal{K} - \mathcal{B}_{,Q} \frac{\dot{Q}}{N} \right). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C4})$$

Since this equals $3Na^2 p_T$, main manuscript, Eq. (171) follows.

4. Continuity identity

Define $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{K}_{,Q} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\rho}_T &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \frac{d}{dt} (Q\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{K}) \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 (\dot{Q}\mathcal{F} + Q\dot{\mathcal{F}} - \mathcal{K}_{,Q}\dot{Q}) \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 (3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q}\dot{Q} + Q\dot{\mathcal{F}}), \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C5})$$

while

$$3H(\rho_T + p_T) = 3HM_{\text{Pl}}^2 (Q\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{B}_{,Q}\dot{Q}). \quad (\text{C6})$$

Their sum is $M_{\text{Pl}}^2 Q(\dot{\mathcal{F}} + 3H\mathcal{F}) = 0$.

5. Acceleration equation

Combining main manuscript, Eq. (168) and main manuscript, Eq. (169) gives

$$\frac{\ddot{a}}{a} = -\frac{1}{6M_{\text{Pl}}^2} \left[\rho_{\text{vis}} + 3p_{\text{vis}} + M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \left(Q \frac{C_T}{a^3} + 2\mathcal{K} - 3\mathcal{B}_{,Q}\dot{Q} \right) \right]. \quad (\text{C7})$$

This equation displays explicitly which clock terms must overcome the positive visible-matter contribution.

Appendix D: Complete Hamiltonian derivation and lapse-operator audit

The following algebraic Legendre derivation applies to the base action S_0 . For the adopted spatial completion use main manuscript, Eq. (80); main manuscript, Eq. (85); main manuscript, Eq. (89); the local specialization and its full operator derivative are in main manuscript, Sec. VII.

This appendix supplies the algebra behind main manuscript, Sec. VI. All functional derivatives are taken at fixed canonical data (h_{ij}, π^{ij}) and fixed visible-sector canonical variables unless stated otherwise.

1. Legendre transform and absence of additional primary constraints

main manuscript, Eq. (97) may be written as

$$\frac{2\pi^{ij}}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}} = K^{ij} - Kh^{ij} + \mathcal{B}h^{ij}. \quad (\text{D1})$$

Taking the trace gives main manuscript, Eq. (98) and main manuscript, Eq. (99); substitution back into equation (D1) gives main manuscript, Eq. (100). The traceless relation is

$$K_{\text{TF}}^{ij} = \frac{2}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}} \pi_{\text{TF}}^{ij}. \quad (\text{D2})$$

The DeWitt kinetic matrix therefore has the GR eigenvalues on the trace and traceless subspaces and is nonsingular for $M_{\text{Pl}}^2 > 0$.

The normal part of the Legendre transform satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} 2\pi^{ij} K_{ij} - \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}}{2} (K_{ij} K^{ij} - K^2 + 2\mathcal{B}K) \\ = \frac{2}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}} \left(\pi_{ij} \pi^{ij} - \frac{1}{2} \pi^2 \right) + \pi \mathcal{B} - \frac{3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}}{4} \mathcal{B}^2. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D3})$$

Adding the intrinsic-curvature, $\mathcal{K}$, $\mathcal{J}$, and matter pieces proves main manuscript, Eq. (103)–main manuscript, Eq. (105). Because neither $\dot{N}$ nor $\dot{N}^i$ occurs and no further velocity degeneracy exists, main manuscript, Eq. (101) is the complete gravitational primary set.

2. Derivation of the exact secondary lapse constraint

Separate the local N -dependent part of $N\mathcal{H}_\perp$ as

$$N\mathcal{U}(Q) = N \left[\pi \mathcal{B} - \frac{3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}}{4} \mathcal{B}^2 - M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} \mathcal{K} \right], \quad Q = N^{-1}. \quad (\text{D4})$$

Since $N\partial_N Q = -Q$,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial[N\mathcal{U}(Q)]}{\partial N} &= \pi(\mathcal{B} - Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q}) \\ &\quad + M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} \left[Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q} - \mathcal{K} - \frac{3}{4} \mathcal{B}^2 + \frac{3}{2} Q\mathcal{B}\mathcal{B}_{,Q} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D5})$$

For the acceleration sector let $\varphi \equiv \eta/N$. Then

$$\delta q_i = D_i \varphi, \quad \delta Y = \frac{2q^i D_i \varphi}{a_0^2}. \quad (\text{D6})$$

The first variation of its Hamiltonian contribution is

$$\begin{aligned} \delta H_J &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int d^3x \sqrt{h} N [a_0^2 \mathcal{J} \varphi + 2\mathcal{J}_{,Y} q^i D_i \varphi] \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int d^3x \sqrt{h} \eta [a_0^2 (\mathcal{J} - 2Y \mathcal{J}_{,Y}) - 2D_i (\mathcal{J}_{,Y} q^i)] + \delta H_{J,\partial\Sigma}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D7})$$

The surface term is

$$\delta H_{J,\partial\Sigma} = 2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int_{\partial\Sigma} d^2x \sqrt{\sigma} n_i \mathcal{J}_{,Y} q^i \eta. \quad (\text{D8})$$

It vanishes for fixed lapse, for the corresponding natural flux condition, or after the boundary functional appropriate to Robin data is included. Combining equations (D5) and (D7) with the N -independent density $\mathcal{H}_0$ gives main manuscript, Eq. (109).

On FLRW, $q_i = 0$, $\pi = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}(-3H + 3\mathcal{B}/2)$, and $\mathcal{J}(0) = 0$. main manuscript, Eq. (109) becomes

$$-3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} H^2 + M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} (Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q} - \mathcal{K} + 3HQ\mathcal{B}_{,Q}) + \sqrt{h} \rho_{\text{vis}} = 0, \quad (\text{D9})$$

which is exactly main manuscript, Eq. (168) with the clock density main manuscript, Eq. (170).

3. Exact second variation and the full functional operator

Let η and ζ be two independent lapse variations and set

$$\varphi = \frac{\eta}{N}, \quad \psi = \frac{\zeta}{N}. \quad (\text{D10})$$

Although $\delta^2 \ln N = -\varphi\psi$ for variations linear in N , all terms proportional to this second variation cancel against the variation of the prefactor N . The exact mixed second variation is therefore

$$\boxed{\delta^2 H_J[\eta, \zeta] = 2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int d^3x \sqrt{h} N \mathbf{P}^{ij} D_i \varphi D_j \psi,} \quad (\text{D11})$$

where $\mathbf{P}^{ij}$ is main manuscript, Eq. (110). Integrating by parts with respect to ψ gives

$$\delta \mathcal{C}_N^{(J)}[\eta] = -\frac{2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}}{N} D_i \left[N \mathbf{P}^{ij} D_j \left(\frac{\eta}{N} \right) \right]. \quad (\text{D12})$$

This expression is symmetric under $\eta \leftrightarrow \zeta$ when the boundary form

$$2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int_{\partial\Sigma} d^2x \sqrt{\sigma} N n_i \mathbf{P}^{ij} (\varphi D_j \psi - \psi D_j \varphi) \quad (\text{D13})$$

vanishes.

For the local part, differentiate equation (D5) with respect to Q and then use $\delta Q = -Q^2 \eta$. One obtains

$$\begin{aligned} \delta \mathcal{C}_N^{(\text{loc})}[\eta] &= Q^3 \pi \mathcal{B}_{,QQ} \eta \\ &\quad - M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} Q^3 \left[\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + \frac{3}{2} \mathcal{B}_{,Q}^2 + \frac{3}{2} \mathcal{B} \mathcal{B}_{,QQ} \right] \eta. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D14})$$

Using $\pi/(M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h}) = 3\mathcal{B}/2 - K$ cancels the terms proportional to $\mathcal{B} \mathcal{B}_{,QQ}$ and leaves

$$\delta \mathcal{C}_N^{(\text{loc})}[\eta] = -M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sqrt{h} Q^3 \left(\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + K \mathcal{B}_{,QQ} + \frac{3}{2} \mathcal{B}_{,Q}^2 \right) \eta. \quad (\text{D15})$$

Equations (D12) and (D15) prove main manuscript, Eq. (111) and main manuscript, Eq. (112). Notice that the value of $\mathcal{B}$ itself drops out: only its first two derivatives enter the lapse Hessian, consistently with the fact that a constant part of $\mathcal{B}\Theta$ is a boundary term.

4. Acceleration-sector Hessian and uniform ellipticity

For a stationary interpolation define

$$\bar{\mu}(s) \equiv 1 + \mathcal{J}_Y(s^2). \quad (\text{D16})$$

For $s > 0$ let $n^i = q^i/(a_0 s)$. The transverse and longitudinal eigenvalues of $\mathbf{P}^i_j$ are

$$p_\perp = \mathcal{J}_Y = \bar{\mu} - 1, \quad p_\parallel = \mathcal{J}_Y + 2Y \mathcal{J}_{YY} = \bar{\mu} - 1 + s \bar{\mu}'(s). \quad (\text{D17})$$

The transverse eigenvalue has multiplicity two. Definiteness of the lapse principal symbol requires both eigenvalues to have the same nonzero sign.

Lemma D.1 (Fast-tail obstruction for an unrenormalized lapse Hessian). *Let*

$$\bar{\mu}(s) = 1 - cs^{-n} + o(s^{-n}), \quad c > 0, \quad n > 1, \quad (\text{D18})$$

with a differentiable remainder whose logarithmic derivative is also $o(s^{-n})$. Then at sufficiently large finite s ,

$$p_\perp = -cs^{-n} + o(s^{-n}) < 0, \quad p_\parallel = (n-1)cs^{-n} + o(s^{-n}) > 0. \quad (\text{D19})$$

Thus a raw coefficient that approaches unity from below faster than s^{-1} cannot give a uniformly definite lapse Hessian.

Proof. Insert Equation (D18) into Equation (D17). Since $s\bar{\mu}'(s) = ncs^{-n} + o(s^{-n})$, Equation (D19) follows. $\square$

SCFT-A uses the finite offset $\gamma_N = 1 + s_N^{-1}$ and the physical interpolation main manuscript, Eq. (54). Writing $S \equiv s_N$,

$$\mu_A(s) = 1 - \delta_S(s), \quad \delta_S(s) = \frac{S^2}{(1+s)(S^2+s^2)}. \quad (\text{D20})$$

It satisfies

$$\mu_A(s) = s + (S^{-2} - 1)s^2 + \mathcal{O}(s^3), \quad s \rightarrow 0, \quad (\text{D21})$$

$$\mu_A(s) = 1 - \frac{S^2}{s^3} + \frac{S^2}{s^4} + \mathcal{O}(s^{-5}), \quad s \rightarrow \infty. \quad (\text{D22})$$

Hence the deep-MOND normalization is exact and the Newtonian correction falls as s^{-3} .

The integral in main manuscript, Eq. (55) has the elementary form

$$\mathcal{J}_A(Y) = -\frac{Y}{S+1} + \frac{S^3}{(S+1)(S^2+1)} \left[2\ln(1+\sqrt{Y}) - \ln\left(1 + \frac{Y}{S^2}\right) - 2S \arctan\left(\frac{\sqrt{Y}}{S}\right) \right]. \quad (\text{D23})$$

Direct differentiation gives

$$1 + \mathcal{J}_{A,Y}(s^2) = \frac{\mu_A(s)}{\gamma_N}. \quad (\text{D24})$$

The small- Y expansion is

$$\mathcal{J}_A(Y) = -Y + \frac{2S}{3(S+1)}Y^{3/2} - \frac{S-1}{2S}Y^2 + \mathcal{O}(Y^{5/2}), \quad (\text{D25})$$

so the composite in the acceleration components is C^2 but not C^3 at the origin.

Define

$$f_S(s) \equiv \mu_A(s) + s\mu'_A(s). \quad (\text{D26})$$

Equation (D24) yields

$$\mathbf{G}^{ij} = g_\perp(h^{ij} - n^i n^j) + g_\parallel n^i n^j, \quad g_\perp = 1 - \frac{\mu_A}{\gamma_N}, \quad g_\parallel = 1 - \frac{f_S}{\gamma_N}. \quad (\text{D27})$$

The transverse bound is

$$g_\perp \geq \frac{1}{S+1}. \quad (\text{D28})$$

Moreover,

$$f_S - 1 = \delta_S \left[\frac{2s^2}{S^2 + s^2} - \frac{1}{1+s} \right] \leq \frac{2S^2 s}{(S^2 + s^2)^2}. \quad (\text{D29})$$

With $x = s/S$,

$$\frac{2S^2 s}{(S^2 + s^2)^2} = \frac{2x}{S(1+x^2)^2} \leq \frac{9}{8\sqrt{3}S}, \quad (\text{D30})$$

where the maximum occurs at $x = 1/\sqrt{3}$. Since $\gamma_N = 1 + S^{-1}$,

$$g_\parallel \geq \frac{1 - 9/(8\sqrt{3})}{S+1} > 0. \quad (\text{D31})$$

These estimates prove the uniform lower bound main manuscript, Eq. (114) and exclude any finite-acceleration signature change of the adopted lapse principal symbol.

The raw weak-field coefficient in the action is $\bar{\mu} = \mu_A/\gamma_N$. Therefore

$$\nabla \cdot \left(\frac{\mu_A}{\gamma_N} \nabla \Phi \right) + \hat{m}_{\text{loc}}^2 \Phi = 4\pi G_* \rho_b \quad (\text{D32})$$

becomes

$$\nabla \cdot (\mu_A \nabla \Phi) + m_{\text{loc}}^2 \Phi = 4\pi G_N \rho_b, \quad G_N = \gamma_N G_*, \quad m_{\text{loc}}^2 = \gamma_N \hat{m}_{\text{loc}}^2. \quad (\text{D33})$$

Thus the finite offset that preserves definiteness of the lapse Hessian leaves the intended physical MOND interpolation unchanged after calibration of the locally measured Newton constant.

5. Coercivity, invertibility, and boundary data

For $\eta = N\varphi$ and $\zeta = N\psi$, equations (D11) and (D15) give

$$-\int d^3x \zeta \Delta_N \eta = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int d^3x \sqrt{h} N [Q^2 \Xi \varphi \psi + 2G^{ij} D_i \varphi D_j \psi]. \quad (\text{D34})$$

Multiplying by the positive lapse is an isomorphism on any domain with the bounds in main manuscript, Eq. (117), so the kernel of Δ_N is isomorphic to the kernel of $\mathcal{L}_N$. For the boundary domains in Definition main manuscript, Sec. VI.1, integration by parts yields main manuscript, Eq. (116), including its Robin surface term when $\sigma_R > 0$. The estimate main manuscript, Eq. (119) follows from $Q \geq N_{\text{max}}^{-1}$ and main manuscript, Eq. (114).

Let $\mathcal{V}$ be the closure of smooth lapse variations satisfying the selected boundary data under the energy norm

$$\|\varphi\|_{\mathcal{V}}^2 = \int d^3x \sqrt{h} (\varphi^2 + D_i \varphi D^i \varphi). \quad (\text{D35})$$

The bilinear form is bounded and coercive on $\mathcal{V}$. Hence, for every source in $\mathcal{V}^*$, there exists a unique $\varphi \in \mathcal{V}$ satisfying the weak lapse or multiplier equation. In particular,

$$\ker \mathcal{L}_N = \{0\}, \quad \ker \Delta_N = \{0\} \quad (\text{D36})$$

on a Dirac-regular component. Compact leaves have no residual homogeneous zero mode because the positive $Q\Xi$ term controls constants. Dirichlet data control the boundary directly. Nonnegative Robin data add the nonnegative surface contribution $2 \int_{\partial\Sigma} \sqrt{\sigma} \sigma_R \varphi^2$. On an asymptotically homogeneous leaf the decay condition removes the boundary flux and the positive local term controls the weighted L^2 norm.

If Ξ merely vanishes, coercivity must be reconsidered rather than inferred from the gradient term. For example, on a compact leaf with pure Neumann data a constant zero mode appears when $\Xi = 0$. This is why main manuscript, Eq. (117) uses a strict lower bound.

6. Constraint matrix, multiplier equation, and bifurcation branches

The local secondary density $\mathcal{H}_i$ alone does not transform the lapse or shift. The primary-extended density $\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_i$ in main manuscript, Eq. (121), equivalently the smeared generator main manuscript, Eq. (120), does, and it obeys

$$\{\mathcal{D}[\xi], \mathcal{D}[\zeta]\} = \mathcal{D}[[\xi, \zeta]], \quad (\text{D37})$$

$$\{P_N[\alpha], \mathcal{D}[\xi]\} = -P_N[\mathcal{L}_\xi \alpha], \quad \{C[\beta], \mathcal{D}[\xi]\} = -C[\mathcal{L}_\xi \beta], \quad (\text{D38})$$

where $[\xi, \zeta]^i = \xi^j \partial_j \zeta^i - \zeta^j \partial_j \xi^i$. The positive sign in the first equation follows directly from the canonical brackets and the generator main manuscript, Eq. (120). The primary shift constraints commute with the lapse chain and close with the spatial generator in the standard way.

The scalar block is main manuscript, Eq. (127), with Ω fixed exactly by main manuscript, Eq. (125) and main manuscript, Eq. (126). Multiplication verifies directly that main manuscript, Eq. (128) is its two-sided inverse. Therefore the scalar block has full rank whenever Δ_N does. Expanding every derivative of the spatial delta distribution

in Ω would lengthen the expression but cannot alter this algebraic result; no bracket has been omitted from the classification.

If Δ_N has an isolated finite-dimensional kernel with basis z_A , the multiplier equation has a solution only if

$$0 = \langle z_A, \mathcal{S} \rangle \equiv \int d^3x z_A \mathcal{S}. \quad (\text{D39})$$

These are the tertiary conditions main manuscript, Eq. (142). Their preservation either fixes the components of λ_N along the kernel, creates further constraints, reveals an additional gauge invariance, or shows that the singular branch has no consistent evolution. The regular and singular branches therefore cannot be joined by simply continuing the three-mode formula through a zero eigenvalue. On a noncompact domain, zero may instead enter the essential spectrum; then the inverse ceases to be bounded and the same regular-branch theorem fails even without an L^2 zero eigenfunction.

7. SCFT-A expression for the local rank scalar

Differentiating main manuscript, Eq. (41) and main manuscript, Eq. (42) gives

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{K}_{A,QQ} &= (1 - W)\mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},QQ} + W\mathcal{K}_{d,QQ} + 2W'(\mathcal{K}_{d,Q} - \mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},Q}) \\ &\quad + W''(\mathcal{K}_d - \mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI}}), \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D40})$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{A,Q} = b_d [W + (Q - Q_d)W'], \quad (\text{D41})$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{A,QQ} = b_d [2W' + (Q - Q_d)W'']. \quad (\text{D42})$$

Substitution into main manuscript, Eq. (139) is the complete benchmark diagnostic. The switch set appearing in main manuscript, Eq. (140) is

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{sw}} = \left[Q_L, 1 + \frac{3\Delta Q}{4} \right] \cup \left[1 + \frac{5\Delta Q}{4}, Q_R \right]. \quad (\text{D43})$$

Outside this compact set, main manuscript, Eq. (136) applies in the unbraided regions and main manuscript, Eq. (138) applies throughout the late plateau. The function in main manuscript, Eq. (140) is continuous on $\mathcal{I}_{\text{sw}}$, so its minimum exists. A parameter point with $\xi_{\text{sw}} > 0$ supplies a connected coercive segment. If $\xi_{\text{sw}} \leq 0$, only the sufficient absolute-value estimate has failed; the exact quantity $\Xi_A(Q, K)$ or the spectrum of $\mathcal{L}_N$ must then be used.

8. Covariant gauge fixing

In the covariant theory, let $\mathcal{H}_\perp^{\text{cov}}$ denote the generator of normal diffeomorphisms before unitary gauge is imposed and choose the gauge condition $\chi_T = T - t = 0$. Its Faddeev–Popov bracket is proportional to

$$\{\chi_T, \mathcal{H}_\perp^{\text{cov}}[\epsilon]\} \propto \epsilon n^\mu \nabla_\mu T = \epsilon Q. \quad (\text{D44})$$

It is nonzero on the domain $Q > 0$. The gauge is therefore locally admissible, and the Stueckelberg restoration of time diffeomorphisms preserves the three physical modes found in main manuscript, result VI.2. This argument does not extend across a zero of Q or a degenerate lapse; such points are gauge-domain boundaries and must be treated in another chart, if they are physically reachable at all.

Appendix E: Controlled asymptotic regimes of $\mathcal{K}(Q)$

1. General series near the matter point

Let

$$\mathcal{K}(Q) = \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{\kappa_n}{n!} (Q - Q_m)^n, \quad \kappa_2 = \kappa_m > 0. \quad (\text{E1})$$

For negligible braiding the current equation is

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{\kappa_n}{(n-1)!} (\delta Q)^{n-1} = \frac{C_T}{a^3}. \quad (\text{E2})$$

Lagrange inversion yields the series in main manuscript, Eq. (189). The exact density and pressure can also be written as

$$\rho_T = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{\kappa_n}{n!} [nQ_m(\delta Q)^{n-1} + (n-1)(\delta Q)^n], \quad (\text{E3})$$

$$p_T = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{\kappa_n}{n!} (\delta Q)^n. \quad (\text{E4})$$

Every analytic $\mathcal{K}$ with a regular positive-curvature extremum therefore has the same leading dust behavior. The higher derivatives determine how rapidly the approximation fails toward early times and how the branch connects to the acceleration regime.

2. DBI sectors used in SCFT-A

Writing $x = Q - 1$, the DBI function main manuscript, Eq. (37) has

$$\mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},Q} = \frac{\kappa_m x}{\sqrt{1 - \lambda_D x^2}}, \quad \mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},QQ} = \frac{\kappa_m}{(1 - \lambda_D x^2)^{3/2}} > 0. \quad (\text{E5})$$

Its Taylor series is

$$\mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI}} = \frac{\kappa_m}{2} x^2 + \frac{\kappa_m \lambda_D}{8} x^4 + \frac{\kappa_m \lambda_D^2}{16} x^6 + \mathcal{O}(x^8), \quad (\text{E6})$$

so $\mathcal{K}_{,QQ}(1) = \kappa_m$ exactly. The compact window main manuscript, Eq. (34) changes the low/intermediate theory only for $Q_L < Q < Q_R$ and makes the braid vanish to all orders at Q_R . The seed DBI profile is used exactly on the exterior interval $Q_b \leq Q \leq Q_L$ and as the matching function at Q_R . The adopted kinetic function replaces the central neighborhood by its plateau and convex interpolation. Solving the current in the condensate-side $W = 0$ region gives main manuscript, Eq. (197)–main manuscript, Eq. (201). The actual high-charge cold hierarchy is supplied by the exponential continuation main manuscript, Eq. (401); main manuscript, Eq. (403).

3. Sound-speed hierarchy

For the unbraided kinetic sector,

$$c_{\text{ad}}^2 = \frac{\mathcal{K}_{,Q}}{Q\mathcal{K}_{,QQ}} \quad (\text{E7})$$

shows that cold behavior requires a hierarchy between the first and second derivatives. A small $\mathcal{K}_{,Q}$ is fixed dynamically by C_T/a^3 , while a large positive $\mathcal{K}_{,QQ}$ suppresses the sound speed. This same large curvature contributes to the local mass scale. The required hierarchy is therefore constrained by both cosmology and galaxies.

Appendix F: SCFT-A endpoint and regularity proofs

The exterior endpoint identities below are unchanged. The local convex matching proof is now main manuscript, Sec. V D, and the adopted acceleration-tip construction is main manuscript, Eq. (58); main manuscript, Eq. (157).

1. Smoothness and branch placement of the fixed clock functions

The flat function f in main manuscript, Eq. (33) is C^∞ and every derivative vanishes at its joining point. Therefore S is C^∞ , equals zero with all derivatives for arguments at or below zero, and equals one with all derivatives of $1 - S$ for arguments at or above one. The product W in main manuscript, Eq. (34) is consequently C^∞ , identically zero outside (Q_L, Q_R) , and identically one on the plateau main manuscript, Eq. (36) containing Q_d .

For every $Q \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{DBI}}$, the DBI radicand is positive:

$$1 - \lambda_D(Q - 1)^2 > 0. \quad (\text{F1})$$

Condition main manuscript, Eq. (39) also puts the closure of the window strictly inside $\mathcal{D}_{\text{DBI}}$. Hence the DBI-based low/intermediate definition is smooth up to Q_R . Above Q_R , smoothness on the larger final domain $\mathcal{D}_Q$ follows from the matched primordial continuation, not from continuing the DBI square root beyond its real interval.

At $Q = 1$, W vanishes on an open neighborhood, so the seed $\mathcal{K}_A$ equals the DBI function and has $\mathcal{B} = 0$ there. The adopted $\tilde{\mathcal{K}}$ instead vanishes on its central plateau; its endpoint identities follow from the convex local construction. At $Q = Q_d$, $W = 1$ on an open neighborhood, so the benchmark equals $\mathcal{K}_d$ and $b_d(Q - Q_d)$ there. Direct differentiation proves main manuscript, Eq. (62)–main manuscript, Eq. (64). At $Q \geq Q_R$, W again vanishes identically, so the braid is absent. The kinetic function beyond this point is the matched high-charge continuation in main manuscript, Sec. XVII B, not the DBI square root.

The placement $Q_d > Q_m$ also removes a kinematic obstruction that would be present in an opposite-side construction. For finite $C_T > 0$, the current equation requires $F = C_T a^{-3} > 0$. At the condensate, the benchmark has

$$F(Q_m, H) = \mathcal{K}_{,Q}(Q_m) + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q}(Q_m) = 0 \quad (\text{F2})$$

for every finite H . A continuous finite-charge solution therefore cannot pass through Q_m . Placing the late point at $Q_d = 1 + \Delta Q$ avoids building an impossible finite-charge crossing into the action.

2. Late fixed-point and reciprocal checks

At $Q = Q_d$, direct substitution gives

$$3H_d^2 + \mathcal{K}(Q_d) = 0, \quad \mathcal{K}_{,Q}(Q_d) + 3H_d\mathcal{B}_{,Q}(Q_d) = -3H_db_d + 3H_db_d = 0. \quad (\text{F3})$$

Moreover, because $\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}(Q_d) = 0$,

$$\mathcal{D}_d = \mathcal{K}_{,QQ}(Q_d) + 3H_d\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}(Q_d) = \kappa_d. \quad (\text{F4})$$

The selected sign assumptions $b_d > 0$ and $-3b_d^2/2 < \kappa_d < 0$ imply $\Xi_d > 0$. The full reciprocal limit additionally uses $Q_d\kappa_d + 3H_db_d > 0$, established with $Q_db_d < 2H_d$. The additional bound $Q_db_d < 2H_d$ is the scalar-gradient condition derived in main manuscript, Sec. XII H. Finally, main manuscript, Eq. (209) becomes

$$\Phi_{,Q}(Q_d) = \kappa_d + \frac{3}{2}b_d^2 > 0, \quad (\text{F5})$$

so the zero of the reduced late-branch function is simple. The source-free scalar kinetic and gradient signs are fixed by main manuscript, Eq. (279).

3. Acceleration-function regularity

The unregulated seed acceleration function is given equivalently by main manuscript, Eq. (55) and (D23). Its derivative is

$$\mathcal{J}_{A,Y}(Y) = \frac{1}{\gamma_N} \left[1 - \frac{1}{(1 + \sqrt{Y})(1 + Y/s_N^2)} \right] - 1. \quad (\text{F6})$$

At $Y = 0$ this equals -1 . Although the separated scalar derivative $\mathcal{J}_{YY}$ diverges as $Y^{-1/2}$, main manuscript, Eq. (230) has the finite limit $-2\delta_{ij}$ in acceleration components. The exact eigenvalue decomposition (D27) and bound main manuscript, Eq. (114) prove more than pointwise C^2 regularity: the grouped Hessian has one sign and a strictly positive inverse-ellipticity margin for every finite acceleration.

Appendix G: Weak-field variation

This appendix records the two-derivative stationary reference calculation. The completed action has the coupled stationary equations and scale restriction stated in the main manuscript; equal potentials and the seed AQUAL limit are not general properties of that completed system.

1. Clock acceleration

For the metric main manuscript, Eq. (211) and stationary $T = t$,

$$u_0 = -N, \quad u_i = 0, \quad \mathcal{A}_i = D_i \ln N = \partial_i \Phi + \mathcal{O}(\Phi^2). \quad (\text{G1})$$

The acceleration action reduces at leading order to

$$S_J \simeq -M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int dt d^3x a_0^2 \mathcal{J} \left(\frac{|\nabla \Phi|^2}{a_0^2} \right). \quad (\text{G2})$$

Its variation with respect to Φ is

$$\delta S_J = 2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \int dt d^3x \delta \Phi \nabla \cdot (\mathcal{J}_Y \nabla \Phi), \quad (\text{G3})$$

up to a boundary term. Adding the Einstein weak-field action therefore replaces $\nabla^2 \Phi$ by

$$\nabla \cdot [(1 + \mathcal{J}_Y) \nabla \Phi]. \quad (\text{G4})$$

2. Local mass term from $\mathcal{K}$

For the formal zero-charge reference background, let $Q_\ell = 1$ and impose

$$\mathcal{K}(1) = \mathcal{K}_{,Q}(1) = 0. \quad (\text{G5})$$

Since $Q = 1 - \Phi + \mathcal{O}(\Phi^2)$,

$$\mathcal{K}(Q) = \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{K}_{,QQ}(1) \Phi^2 + \mathcal{O}(\Phi^3). \quad (\text{G6})$$

With the normalization of main manuscript, Eq. (59), the action-level modified-Poisson equation contains

$$\hat{m}_{\text{loc}}^2 = \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{K}_{,QQ}(1) \quad (\text{G7})$$

when stationary braiding corrections vanish and spatial-completion contributions are omitted. On the adopted exact plateau $\tilde{\mathcal{K}}_{,QQ}(1) = 0$, so this particular local mass coefficient vanishes. The mass coefficient in the physically normalized main manuscript, Eq. (220) is $m_{\text{loc}}^2 = \gamma_N \hat{m}_{\text{loc}}^2$. For the common parametrization $\mathcal{K} = \mu^2(Q - 1)^2$, this gives $\hat{m}_{\text{loc}}^2 = \mu^2$, agreeing with the relativistic-khronon weak-field limit.

Equation (G7) is therefore the mass coefficient of the exact $Q_\ell = 1$ reference branch. A physical local solution matched to $C_T > 0$ has asymptotic $Q = \bar{Q}(t) > 1$ and generally nonzero H ; its effective Helmholtz coefficient is a calculable combination of $\mathcal{K}$, $\mathcal{B}$, and the background equations evaluated there. The reference formula demonstrates the cosmology–galaxy linkage but does not replace that matched calculation.

3. Spherical deep-MOND solution

Outside a spherical baryonic mass M_b , main manuscript, Eq. (226) integrates once to

$$\frac{|\Phi'|}{a_0} \Phi' = \frac{G_N M_b}{r^2}. \quad (\text{G8})$$

On the attractive branch,

$$|\Phi'| = \frac{\sqrt{G_N M_b a_0}}{r}, \quad v_c^4 = G_N M_b a_0. \quad (\text{G9})$$

Thus the baryonic Tully–Fisher scaling follows in the ideal deep-MOND, negligible- m_{loc} regime.

4. Lensing at leading order

The traceless spatial Einstein equation has no leading scalar anisotropic stress on the stationary unitary branch, yielding $\Phi = \Psi$. Null geodesics then respond to $\Phi + \Psi = 2\Phi$, so the force potential and lensing potential agree. This equality is the leading stationary result for the branch defined in this appendix.

Appendix H: Closed homogeneous system

For the fixed functions $\mathcal{K}(Q)$ and $\mathcal{B}(Q)$, the homogeneous equations form the closed system

$$3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 H^2 = \rho_{\text{vis}} + M_{\text{Pl}}^2 (QC_T a^{-3} - \mathcal{K}), \quad (\text{H1})$$

$$\mathcal{K}_{,Q} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,Q} = C_T a^{-3}, \quad (\text{H2})$$

$$\dot{\rho}_A + 3H(\rho_A + p_A) = 0 \quad \text{for each visible species } A. \quad (\text{H3})$$

Together with the pressure in main manuscript, Eq. (171), these equations determine the homogeneous evolution without introducing an independent dark-density continuity equation. Setting $\rho_{\text{vis}} = 0$ gives the algebraic and differential forms used for the global SCFT-A benchmark in main manuscript, Eq. (412); main manuscript, Eq. (414).

Appendix I: Notation

The principal symbols used throughout the paper are collected here. Dimensions refer to units with $c = \hbar = 1$.

$g_{\mu\nu}$:	Universal Lorentzian metric and gravitational field read by all visible matter and tensor waves; dimensionless.
T :	Scalar gravitational clock field; dimension of time.
Q :	Clock norm $\sqrt{-g^{\mu\nu}\nabla_\mu T \nabla_\nu T}$; dimensionless.
u_μ :	Future-directed unit normal $-\nabla_\mu T/Q$; dimensionless.
$h_{\mu\nu}$:	Clock-orthogonal spatial metric $g_{\mu\nu} + u_\mu u_\nu$; dimensionless.
Θ :	Expansion $\nabla_\mu u^\mu$; dimension time $^{-1}$.
$\mathcal{A}_\mu$:	Clock-congruence acceleration $u^\nu \nabla_\nu u_\mu$; dimension time $^{-1}$.
Y :	Acceleration invariant $\mathcal{A}_\mu \mathcal{A}^\mu / a_0^2$; dimensionless.
$\mathcal{K}(Q)$:	Kinetic/condensate function controlling clock density and stiffness; dimension time $^{-2}$.
$\mathcal{B}(Q)$:	Braiding function coupling clock norm to expansion; dimension time $^{-1}$.
$\mathcal{J}(Y)$:	Dimensionless acceleration function whose Hessian enters Δ_N .
a_0 :	Low-acceleration scale entering the weak-field invariant; dimension time $^{-1}$.
s_N, γ_N :	Newtonian-tail transition and $\gamma_N = 1 + s_N^{-1}$; dimensionless.
G_*, G_N :	Action-level and locally measured Newton couplings, $G_N = \gamma_N G_*$; dimension time 2 .
C_T :	Conserved homogeneous clock charge in $a^3 \mathcal{F} = C_T$; dimension time $^{-2}$.
$\mathcal{N}_T$:	Matter proper-time interval per unit clock-field interval, $dt/dT = 1/Q$; dimensionless.
H, H_T :	Expansion rates with respect to matter proper time and clock-field time, with $H_T = H/Q$; dimension time $^{-1}$.
Q_m :	Clock-condensate value defining the matter-like regime; calibrated to $Q_m = 1$ in SCFT-A.
Q_d, H_d :	Displaced late clock value $Q_d = 1 + \Delta Q$ and de Sitter expansion rate; dimensions 1 and time $^{-1}$.

Q_-, Q_+ :	Reference DBI chart boundaries in main manuscript, Eq. (40); the adopted high-charge continuation has no boundary at Q_+ ; dimensionless.
ΔQ :	Positive separation $Q_d - Q_m$ and lower/plateau width scale of the compact braid window; dimensionless.
ν_A :	Upper-switch width constant in main manuscript, Eq. (34); fixed to 30 for the global benchmark; dimensionless.
λ_D :	DBI shape parameter constrained by main manuscript, Eq. (39); dimensionless.
η_R :	Constant intrinsic spatial-curvature-square coefficient $1/(2\kappa_m)$; dimension time^2 .
κ_m, κ_d :	Seed matter-point stiffness and late kinetic curvature; the completed plateau has zero stiffness at $Q = 1$; dimension time^{-2} .
b_d :	Late braiding slope $\mathcal{B}_{,Q}(Q_d)$; dimension time^{-1} .
$\mu_A(s)$:	Physical SCFT-A interpolation $1 - [(1+s)(1+s^2/s_N^2)]^{-1}$; dimensionless.
Ξ :	Local lapse-Hessian scalar $\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + K\mathcal{B}_{,QQ} + 3\mathcal{B}_{,Q}^2/2$; dimension time^{-2} .
$\mathcal{W}_s$:	FLRW scalar momentum-constraint coefficient $2H - Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q}$; dimension time^{-1} .
$\mathcal{D}_s, \Xi_s$:	Combinations $\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}$ and $\mathcal{D}_s + 3\mathcal{B}_{,Q}^2/2$; dimension time^{-2} .
$\mathcal{C}_s$:	Reduced scalar-gradient numerator $-\dot{\mathcal{W}}_s + H\mathcal{W}_s - \mathcal{W}_s^2/2$; dimension time^{-2} .
σ_J :	Homogeneous acceleration coefficient $\Sigma_A(Q)$, equal to one on the local and late plateaux; dimensionless.
r_d, χ_d :	Stable-endpoint variables $Q_d b_d/H_d$ and $-\kappa_d/b_d^2$; dimensionless.
P^{ij}, G^{ij} :	Lapse-gradient Hessian and its positive sign reversal, $G = -P$; dimensionless.
$\mathcal{L}_N$:	Coercive scalar representative of the functional lapse operator; dimension time^{-2} .
Δ_N :	Functional derivative of the lapse constraint; differential operator.
Q_s, F_s, c_s^2 :	Reference-action source-free FLRW scalar coefficients; the completed action uses the distinct K_p, V_p coefficients in the main manuscript.

Appendix J: Complete scalar reduction and infrared audit

This appendix records the base-action S_0 derivation. The completed scalar coefficients replacing it are main manuscript, Eq. (239); the exact local-transition proof is main manuscript, result XIII.1.

This appendix supplies the algebra behind main manuscript, Sec. XII. It is included so that the reduced coefficients can be checked from the fixed action without importing a model-dependent result from another theory.

1. ADM coefficient map

On a proper-time FLRW background the unitary-gauge gravity-clock Lagrangian, before the acceleration term is added, is

$$L_{\text{ADM}} = \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2}{2} [\mathcal{R} + \mathcal{S} - K^2 + 2\mathcal{K}(Q) + 2\mathcal{B}(Q)K], \quad Q = \frac{q(t)}{N}, \quad (\text{J1})$$

where $\mathcal{S} \equiv K_{ij}K^{ij}$ and $q(t) = \dot{T}(t)$. Treating $(N, K, \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{R})$ as independent ADM arguments during differentiation gives

$$\begin{aligned} L_{\mathcal{S}} &= \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2}{2}, & L_{KK} &= -M_{\text{Pl}}^2, \\ L_{KN} &= -M_{\text{Pl}}^2 Q \mathcal{B}_{,Q}, & L_{\mathcal{R}} &= \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2}{2}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{J2})$$

$$2L_N + L_{NN} = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 Q^2 (\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} + 3H\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}) = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 Q^2 \mathcal{D}_s. \quad (\text{J3})$$

The ADM degeneracy combination is

$$L_{KK} + 2L_{\mathcal{S}} = 0, \quad (\text{J4})$$

so the scalar shift remains a constraint rather than acquiring a quadratic kinetic term. The momentum-constraint coefficient is

$$L_{KN} + 4HL_{\mathcal{S}} = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 (2H - Q\mathcal{B}_{,Q}) = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \mathcal{W}_s. \quad (\text{J5})$$

These identities reproduce the general single-field kinetic-gravity-braiding/ADM map [7, 26]. The nonprojectable acceleration term lies outside the minimal $L(N, K, \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{R})$ list but is elementary on FLRW: since $D_i \bar{N} = 0$,

$$Y = \frac{(\partial\alpha)^2}{a^2 a_0^2} + \mathcal{O}(3), \quad -M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a_0^2 \mathcal{J}(Y) = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \sigma_J \frac{(\partial\alpha)^2}{a^2} + \mathcal{O}(3). \quad (\text{J6})$$

This is the higher-spatial-derivative extension of the standard single-field ADM action [26].

2. Geometric expansion

To first order,

$$\delta K^i_j = (\dot{\zeta} - H\alpha) \delta^i_j - \frac{1}{a^2} \partial^i \partial_j \psi, \quad (\text{J7})$$

$$\delta K = 3(\dot{\zeta} - H\alpha) - \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{a^2}, \quad (\text{J8})$$

$$\delta_1 \mathcal{R} = -\frac{4}{a^2} \partial^2 \zeta, \quad \delta_2 \mathcal{R} = -\frac{2}{a^2} [(\partial\zeta)^2 - 4\zeta \partial^2 \zeta]. \quad (\text{J9})$$

The clock norm obeys

$$Q = \frac{q}{1 + \alpha} = Q(1 - \alpha + \alpha^2) + \mathcal{O}(3), \quad (\text{J10})$$

where the unperturbed Q on the right-hand side is $q(t)$. Substitution into Equation (J1), use of the two background equations, and integration by parts give main manuscript, Eq. (255). No background reconstruction or subhorizon approximation is used.

For a compact verification, define

$$u \equiv \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{a^2}, \quad v \equiv \frac{\partial^2 \zeta}{a^2}, \quad A_s \equiv Q^2 \mathcal{D}_s - 6H^2 + 6HQ\mathcal{B}_{,Q}. \quad (\text{J11})$$

Then the part of the Lagrangian needed for the constraints is

$$\frac{\mathcal{L}_s^{(2)}}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^3} = -3\dot{\zeta}^2 + \mathcal{W}_s \alpha (3\dot{\zeta} - u) + 2\dot{\zeta}u + \frac{1}{2} A_s \alpha^2 - 2\alpha v + \frac{(\partial\zeta)^2}{a^2} + \sigma_J \frac{(\partial\alpha)^2}{a^2}. \quad (\text{J12})$$

Variation with respect to u yields main manuscript, Eq. (256). In Fourier space, variation with respect to α yields

$$(A_s + 2\sigma_J x) \alpha + 3\mathcal{W}_s \dot{\zeta} - \mathcal{W}_s u + 2x\zeta = 0. \quad (\text{J13})$$

The key exact identity is

$$3\mathcal{W}_s^2 + 2A_s = 2Q^2 \left(\mathcal{D}_s + \frac{3}{2} \mathcal{B}_{,Q}^2 \right) = 2Q^2 \Xi_s. \quad (\text{J14})$$

main manuscript, Eq. (256), (J13), and (J14) immediately give main manuscript, Eq. (258); main manuscript, Eq. (260).

3. Reduction and integration by parts

After substituting $\alpha = 2\dot{\zeta}/\mathcal{W}_s$, all dependence on u cancels identically. For one real Fourier mode,

$$\frac{\mathcal{L}_s^{(2)}}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 a^3} = \frac{2(Q^2 \Xi_s + 2\sigma_J x)}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} \dot{\zeta}^2 + \frac{4x}{\mathcal{W}_s} \zeta \dot{\zeta} + x \zeta^2. \quad (\text{J15})$$

Since $a^3 x = ak^2$,

$$\frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{a^3 x}{\mathcal{W}_s} \right) = a^3 x \left(\frac{H}{\mathcal{W}_s} - \frac{\dot{\mathcal{W}}_s}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} \right). \quad (\text{J16})$$

Therefore

$$\int dt a^3 \frac{4x}{\mathcal{W}_s} \zeta \dot{\zeta} = -2 \int dt a^3 x \left(\frac{H}{\mathcal{W}_s} - \frac{\dot{\mathcal{W}}_s}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} \right) \zeta^2, \quad (\text{J17})$$

up to a boundary term. Combining this with the last term in Equation (J15) gives

$$1 - \frac{2H}{\mathcal{W}_s} + \frac{2\dot{\mathcal{W}}_s}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} = -\frac{2\mathcal{C}_s}{\mathcal{W}_s^2}, \quad (\text{J18})$$

which proves main manuscript, Eq. (261); main manuscript, Eq. (262); main manuscript, Eq. (263) including every numerical factor.

The Euler–Lagrange equation is

$$\frac{d}{dt} (a^3 Q_s \dot{\zeta}_{\mathbf{k}}) + a^3 F_s \frac{k^2}{a^2} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}} = 0. \quad (\text{J19})$$

The Legendre transformation of main manuscript, Eq. (261) gives main manuscript, Eq. (270); main manuscript, Eq. (271); hence the sign conditions in main manuscript, result XII.3 are both necessary and sufficient for positivity of the two quadratic terms on that patch.

4. Late-endpoint algebra

At the exact endpoint $\dot{H} = \dot{Q} = 0$, $\mathcal{B}_{,Q} = b_d$, and $\mathcal{B}_{,QQ} = 0$. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{W}_{s,d} &= 2H_d - Q_d b_d, \\ \mathcal{C}_{s,d} &= H_d \mathcal{W}_{s,d} - \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{W}_{s,d}^2 = \frac{1}{2} Q_d b_d \mathcal{W}_{s,d}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{J20})$$

$$\Xi_{s,d} = \kappa_d + \frac{3}{2} b_d^2. \quad (\text{J21})$$

The original signs $b_d < 0$, $\kappa_d > 0$ make $\mathcal{C}_{s,d} < 0$ because $\mathcal{W}_{s,d} > 0$. The corrected region main manuscript, Eq. (279) follows by requiring, independently,

$$b_d \mathcal{W}_{s,d} > 0, \quad \Xi_{s,d} > 0, \quad \frac{\mathcal{W}_{s,d}}{Q_d \kappa_d + 3H_d b_d} > 0. \quad (\text{J22})$$

The choice $b_d > 0$, $\mathcal{W}_{s,d} > 0$, and $\kappa_d > -3b_d^2/2$ implies $Q_d \kappa_d + 3H_d b_d > 0$. Restricting further to $\kappa_d < 0$ gives the sufficient benchmark subset in main manuscript, Eq. (279); the inequalities do not require negative κ_d for all possible stable reciprocal endpoints.

5. Independent covariant-clock Minkowski reduction

The strict Minkowski boundary is most transparently audited before imposing unitary gauge. With the variables in main manuscript, Eq. (285), define $A_k \equiv \alpha_M k^2 + \mu^2$. The Fourier Lagrangian corresponding to main manuscript, Eq. (288) is

$$\frac{L_k}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2} = -3|\dot{\Psi}|^2 + k^2|\Psi|^2 - k^2(\Phi\Psi^* + \Phi^*\Psi) + A_k|\dot{\sigma} - \Phi|^2. \quad (\text{J23})$$

For a real mode, the lapse equation gives

$$A_k(\dot{\sigma} - \Phi) = -k^2\Psi. \quad (\text{J24})$$

The canonical momenta are

$$P_\Psi = -6M_{\text{Pl}}^2\dot{\Psi}, \quad P_\sigma = 2M_{\text{Pl}}^2A_k(\dot{\sigma} - \Phi), \quad P_\Phi = 0. \quad (\text{J25})$$

The lapse constraint is equivalently

$$P_\sigma + 2M_{\text{Pl}}^2k^2\Psi = 0. \quad (\text{J26})$$

Preservation of this constraint fixes $P_\Psi = 0$; no oscillatory scalar frequency remains. Substitution into the canonical Hamiltonian leaves

$$\begin{aligned} H_{k,\text{dec}}^{(2)} &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \left(\frac{k^4}{A_k} - k^2 \right) |\Psi|^2 \\ &= M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \frac{(1 - \alpha_M)k^2 - \mu^2}{\alpha_M k^2 + \mu^2} k^2 |\Psi|^2, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{J27})$$

which proves main manuscript, Eq. (289). This agrees with the quadratic Hamiltonian of the neighboring relativistic khronon action [8]. Setting $\alpha_M = 1$ proves main manuscript, Eq. (290). The conclusion is deliberately limited to the second variation. The nonlinear $Y^{3/2}$ term is of higher perturbative order and cannot be used to change a quadratic coefficient, although it can alter global boundedness at finite amplitude.

6. Independent unitary-ADM Minkowski reduction

The same boundary can be derived directly from the unreduced ADM action, which is valid before division by $\mathcal{W}_s$. At $H = 0$, $Q = 1$, $a = 1$, and $\mathcal{B}_{,Q}(1) = 0$, main manuscript, Eq. (255) gives, for a real mode,

$$\frac{L_{k,\text{ADM}}^{(2)}}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2} = -3\dot{\zeta}_k^2 - 2k^2\dot{\zeta}_k\psi_k + \frac{1}{2}(\kappa_m + 2\sigma_J k^2)\alpha_k^2 + 2k^2\alpha_k\zeta_k + k^2\zeta_k^2. \quad (\text{J28})$$

Variation with respect to ψ_k imposes $\dot{\zeta}_k = 0$ for $k \neq 0$. The lapse equation and its solution are

$$(\kappa_m + 2\sigma_J k^2)\alpha_k + 2k^2\zeta_k = 0, \quad \alpha_k = -\frac{2k^2\zeta_k}{\kappa_m + 2\sigma_J k^2}. \quad (\text{J29})$$

After eliminating α_k and changing sign from the static reduced Lagrangian to the Hamiltonian,

$$H_{k,\text{ADM}}^{(2)} = M_{\text{Pl}}^2 k^2 \frac{2(1 - \sigma_J)k^2 - \kappa_m}{\kappa_m + 2\sigma_J k^2} |\zeta_k|^2. \quad (\text{J30})$$

For $\sigma_J = 1$ and $\mu^2 = \kappa_m/2$ this is exactly equation (J27), because $\zeta = -\Psi$ for the two metric conventions. This proves gauge agreement without assuming a nonsingular curvature-gauge solution for the shift.

7. Positive-charge DBI sector and order of limits

On an unbraided DBI component, the exact current is $\mathcal{K}_{,Q} = C_T a^{-3}$. Set

$$Z \equiv \frac{C_T}{\kappa_m a^3}, \quad R \equiv \sqrt{1 + \lambda_D Z^2}, \quad \delta Q \equiv Q - 1 = \frac{Z}{R}. \quad (\text{J31})$$

Direct differentiation of main manuscript, Eq. (37) gives

$$\mathcal{K}_{,Q} = \frac{\kappa_m \delta Q}{\sqrt{1 - \lambda_D \delta Q^2}} = \kappa_m Z, \quad (\text{J32})$$

$$\mathcal{K}_{,QQ} = \frac{\kappa_m}{(1 - \lambda_D \delta Q^2)^{3/2}} = \kappa_m R^3. \quad (\text{J33})$$

The source-free Friedmann equation then reads

$$3H^2 = Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q} - \mathcal{K} = \kappa_m \left[Z + \frac{R-1}{\lambda_D} \right], \quad (\text{J34})$$

and the acceleration equation gives

$$-2\dot{H} = Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q} = Q\kappa_m Z. \quad (\text{J35})$$

For $C_T > 0$ and finite a , all quantities on the right-hand sides of equations (J32)–(J35) are strictly positive. Substitution into the exact reduced action yields main manuscript, Eq. (297)–main manuscript, Eq. (299). This proves main manuscript, Proposition XII.4 algebraically, with no numerical scan.

To examine the boundary, expand

$$R = 1 + \frac{1}{2}\lambda_D Z^2 - \frac{1}{8}\lambda_D^2 Z^4 + \mathcal{O}(Z^6). \quad (\text{J36})$$

Equations (J34)–(J35) then give the asymptotic series in main manuscript, Eq. (300)–main manuscript, Eq. (303). In particular, $Q_s \propto Z^{-1}$ and $\mathcal{W}_s \propto Z^{1/2}$, so the curvature-gauge transformation becomes singular as the dynamically conserved charge density vanishes. The two operations

$$\lim_{Z \rightarrow 0^+} (\text{reduce at } Z > 0) \quad \text{and} \quad (\text{set } Z = 0 \text{ and then reduce}) \quad (\text{J37})$$

do not commute. This is the exact mathematical origin of the apparent conflict between the positive expanding branch and the negative strict-Minkowski Hessian.

For a further independent check, use

$$4\pi G_*(\rho_T + p_T) = \frac{1}{2}Q\mathcal{K}_{,Q}, \quad c_{\text{ad}}^2 = \frac{\mathcal{K}_{,Q}}{Q\mathcal{K}_{,QQ}}. \quad (\text{J38})$$

Then the published GDM form

$$c_s^2 = c_{\text{ad}}^2 \left[1 + \frac{c_{\text{ad}}^2 k^2}{4\pi G_* a^2 (\rho_T + p_T)} \right]^{-1} \quad (\text{J39})$$

reduces identically to main manuscript, Eq. (276). Thus the positive-charge result agrees with the independent perturbative reduction of the unbraided khronon sector [8].

8. Matter-point braid no-go

Let $b_m = \mathcal{B}_{,Q}(1)$ while preserving the constant exact Minkowski background. From main manuscript, Eq. (252)–main manuscript, Eq. (254),

$$\mathcal{W}_s = -b_m, \quad \Xi_s = \kappa_m + \frac{3}{2}b_m^2, \quad C_s = -\frac{1}{2}b_m^2. \quad (\text{J40})$$

If $b_m \neq 0$, the reduced gradient coefficient is

$$F_s = \frac{4M_{\text{Pl}}^2 C_s}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} = -2M_{\text{Pl}}^2. \quad (\text{J41})$$

This is independent of the magnitude and sign of b_m . If $b_m = 0$, the curvature reduction degenerates and the direct calculation reverts to main manuscript, Eq. (290). Since $H = \dot{Q} = 0$, neither $\mathcal{B}_{,QQ}$ nor higher derivatives contribute to the quadratic invariants. This proves main manuscript, Proposition XII.5.

9. Algebraic cross-checks

The following identities were checked independently by symbolic algebra:

$$3 + \frac{2(A_s + 2\sigma_J x)}{\mathcal{W}_s^2} = \frac{2(Q^2 \Xi_s + 2\sigma_J x)}{\mathcal{W}_s^2}, \quad (\text{J42})$$

$$H_d \mathcal{W}_{s,d} - \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{W}_{s,d}^2 = \frac{1}{2} Q_d b_d (2H_d - Q_d b_d), \quad (\text{J43})$$

$$\mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},QQ} = \frac{\kappa_m}{[1 - \lambda_D(Q-1)^2]^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},Q}}{Q \mathcal{K}_{\text{DBI},QQ}} = \frac{(Q-1)[1 - \lambda_D(Q-1)^2]}{Q}, \quad (\text{J44})$$

$$H_{k,\text{ADM}}^{(2)}|_{\sigma_J=1, \kappa_m=2\mu^2} = -M_{\text{Pl}}^2 \frac{\mu^2 k^2}{k^2 + \mu^2} |\zeta_k|^2, \quad (\text{J45})$$

$$\lim_{Z \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{Z Q_s(t, 0)}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2} = 3, \quad \lim_{Z \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{F_s}{M_{\text{Pl}}^2} = 3, \quad \lim_{Z \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{c_s^2(t, 0)}{Z} = 1, \quad (\text{J46})$$

$$F_{s,m}|_{\mathcal{B}, Q(1) \neq 0} = -2M_{\text{Pl}}^2. \quad (\text{J47})$$

The symbolic checks also verify the exact equality of equations (J39) and main manuscript, Eq. (276). They supplement, but do not replace, the analytical derivations.

Appendix K: Exact checks for the completed local transition

The completed unbraided quadratic action is main manuscript, Eq. (318). Its auxiliary determinant, scalar coefficients, all seven positivity polynomial coefficients, switch derivative terms, ultraviolet limits, Ricci principal identity, and Kasner relations are independently checked by the embedded `scft_rank1_checks.py`. All arithmetic is exact. The test report verifies algebraic identities; it does not establish the nonlinear analytic hypotheses in main manuscript, result XIV.4. The current general braided auxiliary formulas are additionally checked by `scft_completion_checks.py`. Old momentum-independent trace repair formulas are not formulas of main manuscript, Eq. (59).

Appendix L: Matter reduction and homogeneous matching identities

1. Fluid action and perturbation variables

For each visible species,

$$S_A = - \int d^4x [\sqrt{-g} \rho_A(n_A) + J_A^\mu \partial_\mu \ell_A], \quad n_A = \sqrt{\frac{g_{\mu\nu} J_A^\mu J_A^\nu}{g}}. \quad (\text{L1})$$

The current J_A^μ is a vector density and ℓ_A imposes particle-number conservation. Expanding to second order, eliminating the auxiliary current perturbation, and combining background-equation terms with the gravity-clock sector yields main manuscript, Eq. (376).

2. Full auxiliary quadratic form

In the variables of main manuscript, Sec. XV A, the auxiliary part of the action is the quadratic form in main manuscript, Eq. (237), together with $\mathcal{V}\chi - \alpha\Delta_\rho - 3\mathcal{V}\zeta$. Its Hessian determinant is $-M_{\text{Pl}}^4 \mathcal{D}$. Completing its two-variable square gives the full reduced functional main manuscript, Eq. (381). The coefficient of $\zeta\dot{\zeta}$ before integration by parts is $2M_{\text{Pl}}^2 B$. The accompanying exact checker verifies the gravity auxiliary elimination with the curvature term present. The displayed matter source terms follow by the same linear auxiliary inversion.

3. Rank-one inverse

For $x > 0$ and $\mathcal{P}_{\text{full}} \neq 0$, the exact inverse is

$$\mathbf{R}_{\text{full}}^{-1} = \frac{1}{x} \mathbf{H}^{-1} + \frac{E}{M_{\text{pl}}^2 \mathcal{D}} \frac{\mathbf{1} \mathbf{1}^T}{x \mathcal{P}_{\text{full}}}. \quad (\text{L2})$$

The matrix determinant lemma gives main manuscript, Eq. (383) for any number of species. Substitution into the velocity quadratic form gives main manuscript, Eq. (384). This optional density-only elimination is not used to evolve the response across a zero of $\mathcal{P}_{\text{full}}$; the canonical system contains no division by that quantity.

4. High-charge matching

At $Q_R = 193/100$, the low/intermediate SCFT-A profile is exactly unbraided DBI. Because V_K and all of its derivatives vanish at Q_R , the logarithmic slope main manuscript, Eq. (397) matches ϱ_{DBI} to every order there. At $Q_E = 199/100$, $1 - V_K$ and all of its derivatives vanish, so ϱ_A matches the constant λ_∞ to every order. Solving $d\mathcal{F}_K/dQ = \varrho_A \mathcal{F}_K$ and then integrating $\mathcal{K}_{,Q} = \mathcal{F}_K$ proves that main manuscript, Eq. (399) is C^∞ . Positivity follows directly from main manuscript, Eq. (400).

For $Q \geq Q_E$,

$$\frac{p_T}{\rho_T} = \frac{K_E + (F - F_E)/\lambda_\infty}{QF - K_E - (F - F_E)/\lambda_\infty} \rightarrow \frac{1}{\lambda_\infty Q - 1}, \quad (\text{L3})$$

as $F = C_T a^{-3} \rightarrow \infty$, confirming the cold asymptote independently of main manuscript, Eq. (403).

Appendix M: Curvature-completed algebra and numerical reproducibility

1. Action provenance and exact checks

The supplied `scft_curvature_completion.py` derives the endpoint rational expression, verifies its positive-coefficient polynomial, and independently eliminates the lapse and shift from the corrected quadratic action. It verifies the unchanged kinetic term, the added $8\eta_R p^4$ restoring term, auxiliary Hessian, zero added lapse Hessian, and intrinsic-curvature cubic vertex. All 16 implemented exact checks pass. They are algebraic checks of the displayed correction; they do not certify observational viability or the conditional nonlinear energy estimate.

The positive endpoint proof uses the entire exact interval $0 < \delta < 10^{-6}$. The numerical response uses the inherited numerical evaluation printed in the supplied source,

$$\delta_{\text{num}} \simeq 8.0835430681749942437868886561856776507281743783432 \times 10^{-60}. \quad (\text{M1})$$

This is an uncertified extrema evaluation, and its full printed precision has not been independently established here. The current script stores that input string and uses its binary64 conversion; it does not repeat or certify the extrema search defining the action. No decimal approximation enters the exact endpoint positivity proof. The existing exact local-transition proof also continues to use main manuscript, Eq. (332), rather than this numerical value.

2. Refinement and independent integrators

For the common output grid define

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_{\text{pt}} &= \max_{X,i} \frac{|X_{\text{fine}}(N_i) - X_{\text{coarse}}(N_i)|}{\max\{1, |X_{\text{fine}}(N_i)|\}}, \\ \mathcal{E}_{\text{ch}} &= \max_X \frac{\max_i |X_{\text{fine}}(N_i) - X_{\text{coarse}}(N_i)|}{\max\{1, \max_i |X_{\text{fine}}(N_i)|\}}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{M2})$$

Here the verification channels include the eight evolved variables, reconstructed lapse, both Newtonian potentials, and three Newtonian density contrasts. The response maximum in the main text uses only the six explicitly listed observable channels.

Diagnostic	Stored numerical approximation
Largest channel-normalized refinement discrepancy	$2.1305686436021848 \times 10^{-11}$
Largest pointwise-scaled refinement discrepancy	$2.1305686436021848 \times 10^{-11}$
Largest scaled background-constraint residual	$4.8722137239064966 \times 10^{-14}$
Largest scaled lapse-constraint residual	$2.311988990329955 \times 10^{-16}$
Largest scaled shift-constraint residual	$1.7211709488207383 \times 10^{-18}$
Largest scaled metric-slip identity residual	$3.83065356439837 \times 10^{-18}$
DOP853–RK45 discrepancy at $k/H_d = 0.03$	$9.320686583658144 \times 10^{-13}$
DOP853–RK45 discrepancy at $k/H_d = 10.0$	$2.89308507706032 \times 10^{-15}$
DOP853–RK45 discrepancy at $k/H_d = 1000.0$	$9.413478893952054 \times 10^{-12}$

The independent-integrator rows use $\mathcal{E}_{\text{ch}}$. Constraint residuals are divided by the maximum of one and the absolute terms in each constraint. These are finite-grid arithmetic and convergence checks, not interval certificates for continuum extrema. Ordinary floating-point results are reported as approximations; no mathematical identity is inferred from equality of rounded displays.

3. Data products

The verification archive includes the executed Python script, exact check report, loaded background on $1 \leq a \leq 10$, corrected endpoint spectrum, all 42 responses in NPZ format, representative CSV time series, per-mode diagnostics, and a numerical summary. Its README states units, dependencies, action coefficient, input precision, initial conditions, and rerun command. All figures are embedded in the TeX source, so the manuscript compiles without external figure files. The unchanged broad-range homogeneous figure is retained from the supplied source; its plotted coordinates are also exported in the archive. The current response calculation independently solves the background constraints over its stated interval.

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DATA AVAILABILITY

Code, exact checks, and numerical response data are available in the SCFT-A GitHub repository, inspected at commit 2355864.